

that otherwise aren't put to any good use. These purchases serve no other practical purpose than to massage our egos for scalping a good deal and just end up gathering dust in the attic. The smart shopper doesn't let discounts dictate his purchases, but rather sniffs the markets for discounts on the products that he expressly needs. The best way to achieve that is by getting organised. Make a list of your needs and choose products accordingly. That way, you know what to buy instead of committing the virtual equivalent of window shopping on e-commerce portals. The true mark of a smart shopper is that their online shopping excursions are akin to a Mossad covert operation. Fast in, fast out and they're done before anyone knows what's happened.

CHOOSING THE RIGHT E-TAILER

When you get down to deal hunting through web searches, you'll find plenty of obscure e-commerce websites. It goes without saying that patronising these websites over established giants such as Amazon, Flipkart, Paytm, and Snapdeal is risky. But what if the deal is too good to pass off? I personally would dismiss this as something being too good to be true. However, you can perform a web search for the reputation of the e-commerce portal and ascertain if there are any complaints against it. Any web search that throws up a lot of negative results should be treated as a red flag. As a thumb rule, it's safer to stick to established players since these e-tailers have the necessary infrastructure to make your online shopping experience fast, pleasant, and risk free.

Having said that, it's not just down to the reputation of the e-commerce portal. If you pay attention, these portals essentially serve as marketplaces for smaller sellers, distributors, and even companies selling their products whilst bypassing the intermediaries. So when buying something, it pays to perform a quick check on these sellers themselves. From Amazon and Flipkart to eBay, each e-commerce portal has a rating and feedback system set in place to encourage quality service. So the next time you scour through the list of sellers offering the best price for a particular item, be



Flipkart's Big Billion Day. Where hype doesn't always translate into great deals

mindful of the seller's rating as well. It helps with making a value judgement on whether it's prudent to save a few bucks and go for a three-star rated seller instead of the five-star rated one.

The more experienced and consistently well performing sellers are distinguished by special badges that serve as a stamp of approval. For example, Amazon India identifies them as Fulfilled by Amazon, whereas Flipkart dubs them as Flipkart Advantage retailers. It's basically a sign that these sellers stand scrutiny to the high standards related to shipping, returns, and other policies dictated by the portal. Also, pay atten-

tion to sales fulfilled by the e-tailers themselves, as that's the most reliable option when returns and shipping are concerned. Flipkart sells stuff through its own portal as WS Retail, whereas Cloudtail is the same for Amazon India. Buying products from these sellers is the safest option by far, as you're assured of the authenticity of the product, smoother returns experience, as well as quick shipment and delivery.

KEEPING TABS THROUGH WISH LISTS

What good are personal lists if all they're going to do is languish in an excel sheet or a piece of paper? This is where wish lists come into play. Any online shopping portal worth its salt will have this feature implemented within its UI. The purpose of having wishlists on these websites isn't restricted to folks mooching gifts off desperate pleasure seekers. When used right, it not only serves as a means for friends and family to have an informed opinion on the ideal gift for you, but it can also be used to keep track of excellent deals on the products that you want to buy. That sure beats grabbing just any odd product just because it's marked down heavily on account of a promotional offer.

Wish lists on e-commerce portals such as Amazon tell you exactly how the price of the product you're watching has changed, by how much, and in what direction. Websites with more dynamic and flexible approach to pricing such

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StickyPoll: How much can I sell my old stuff for? Started by freelock_benny_digi, 05-04-2011 09:15 PM 1 2 3 4 5 ... 196	Replies: 1,952 Views: 130,477	Hishi 29-09-2015, 09:07 AM
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Sticky: How to Safely Pack Products for Shipping: Also, post your pictures Started by Tarida, 17-05-2011 05:08 PM 1 2 3	Replies: 20 Views: 18,663	Sisal 18-04-2012, 11:58 PM
Sticky: *** Bazaar section rules (updated) *** Started by Ico, 07-12-2010 01:00 AM	Replies: 0 Views: 22,135	Ico 07-12-2010, 01:00 AM
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The marketplace on Digit forum is great for finding group deals from distributors themselves